

Baking Instruction — Classic Sourdough

Production · 2025-06 · Revision D

1. Scope

This instruction covers the making of the Classic Sourdough, product code SD-12, from mixed dough to the point of final inspection. It applies at every site that bakes the product.

Field	Entry
Instruction	BI-SD12
Revision	Revision D
Issued	2025-06
Supersedes	Revision C
Applies to	Classic Sourdough (SD-12)

This revision is issued under RC-91. The revision introduces steam at the start of the bake and a core temperature check. No other provision of the instruction is altered by this revision.

Bakers shall work to the current revision only. Superseded revisions are withdrawn from the bakery floor and kept by Production for record purposes. Where a superseded revision is found at a workstation it shall be returned to Production and replaced.

2. Equipment

Equipment required for the product is listed below. Equipment shall be clean and in working order at the start of each shift. Equipment found faulty shall not be used and shall be reported to the shift supervisor.

Item	Specification	Check
Deck oven	Stone deck, with steam	Daily
Proving baskets	Cane, 1 kg size	Each use
Scoring blade	Single edge, in holder	Each shift
Probe thermometer	Reads to one degree	Weekly against reference

The probe thermometer shall be wiped with a sanitising wipe before and after each use. A thermometer that has not been checked against the reference in the past week shall not be used for this product.

Proving baskets shall be brushed out after each use and left to dry. Baskets that are damp or show mould shall be taken out of use.

Scoring blades shall be changed at the start of each shift. A blunt blade drags the dough and spoils the shape of the loaf.

3. Shaping and proving

Dough arrives divided and rested. Each piece is shaped into a round, placed seam side up in a floured proving basket and covered.

Step	Operation	Check
3.1	Shape each piece into a tight round	Visual
3.2	Place seam side up in a floured basket	Visual
3.3	Cover and prove until risen by half	Poke test
3.4	Record the prove on the build sheet	Build sheet

A loaf is ready when a floured finger leaves a dent that springs back slowly. A dent that springs back at once means the loaf needs longer. A dent that does not spring back means the loaf has proved too far and shall be reshaped.

Proving is complete when every loaf on the rack has passed the poke test. Loaves shall not go forward to baking with a failed check.

4. Baking

The loaves are baked in the deck oven, directly on the stone. Confirm before starting that the stone is clean and that no crumbs or burnt flour are left from the previous bake; burnt flour marks the base of the loaf and gives a bitter taste.

Turn each loaf out of its basket onto the loading peel, seam side down. Handle the loaf gently so that it keeps the gas built up during proving. A loaf that collapses when turned out has proved too far and shall be set aside for reshaping rather than baked.

Score each loaf with a single cut across the top before loading. Scoring lets the loaf open in a controlled way as it rises in the heat. A loaf that is not scored will tear at the side, and a torn loaf fails final inspection.

Loaves shall be loaded with space between them. Do not let loaves touch on the stone and do not load more than the rack sheet allows. Loaves that touch bake unevenly, stay pale where they meet, and leave soft patches in the crust that shorten the life of the product.

Bake with steam for the first 10 minutes. Set it to 230 °C. Check the core temperature after 35 minutes.

The core temperature check is required to confirm the centre of the loaf is fully baked. The reading shall be recorded on the build sheet against the batch number. A batch released without a recorded reading is not conforming and shall be held until the check has been made.

Step	Operation	Record
4.1	Confirm stone clean	Build sheet
4.2	Turn out and score each loaf	Visual
4.3	Load with space between loaves	Visual
4.4	Bake as specified, with steam	Build sheet
4.5	Check and record core temperature	Build sheet

5. Inspection

Final inspection is carried out when the loaves have cooled on the rack for one hour.

Check	Method	Acceptance
Crust colour	Visual against the colour card	Within the card range
Shape	Visual	Round, opened along the score
Base	Tap	Sounds hollow
Weight	Scale	Within tolerance for the product

Loaves that fail inspection are recorded on the waste sheet and are not sold. The build sheet is signed by the baker and kept under the records procedure.